

Because of
B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.
IMC Analysis and Strategy

Group 4

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Executive Summary

Overview

This marketing campaign is made for *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.*, a non-profit 501(c)(3) organization based in Summerville, South Carolina. The organization was founded in 2010 by Michelle Zieg, after the tragic drowning of her infant son, to educate the public-specific families, youth and the community--on water safety and awareness.

While *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* benefits from a sympathetic cause and strong connections, it currently faces challenges stemming from a lack of staff and time. Key weaknesses include low brand awareness outside the organization's local region and a lack of stable donations. *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* effectively competes for the attention of donors with other non-profit organizations, making it prudent that a strategy be in place to increase the organization's perceived value, awareness, and trust with donors to raise donations. The marketing plan set forth is designed to address those concerns.

Target Market

The campaign primarily targets parents and caregivers with children aged 0-8 years old, particularly those living in Charleston and surrounding coastal communities in South Carolina. These individuals are actively involved in children's early learning and prioritize protection, prevention, and family well-being.

Campaign Objectives

This campaign is designed to increase awareness and refresh the image of the brand.

Specifically, this campaign seeks to:

- Reach new communities
- Improve SEO
- Bring in email subscribers
- Increase followers and engagement across social media platforms
- Increase number of repeat donors and donations

Strategic Recommendations

This campaign uses a multi-channel approach to address the current weaknesses and take hold of current opportunities. Our recommendations include:

- **Physical Flyers** with water safety information that can be posted anywhere
- A **Complete Website Refresh** to improve user experience and SEO.
- **Email Refresh** to keep people engaged and updated with the organization.
- Use of **Canva's Brand Kit** and **Content Calendar** tools to automate and standardize content across social media platforms.
- A **Social Media Reel Series** to spread awareness and encourage people to follow *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.*'s social media accounts.
- A **Swim Meet Fundraiser** for the community to compete, learn about water safety, and have a good time while raising money.
- **Education Sessions** that go over basics of pool and water safety

Budget & Timeline

The campaign is estimated to have a cost of \$2,000. Implementation of the campaign begins in March 2026 and runs through February 2027, with monthly content calendars and a mixture of fundraising events and school visits.

The Client: *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* / Michelle Zieg

Founded in 2010 by Michelle Zieg, Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. is a nonprofit based in Summerville, South Carolina. After tragedy struck the Zieg family when Michelle's infant son Brayden tragically drowned in the family pool, Michelle took it upon herself to spread the word of water safety. The purpose is to educate families and the community about the importance of water awareness through learning materials that are accessible and informative. By leveraging fellow non-profits, educational resources, children's activities, and a recent endorsement by Michael Phelps, Michelle seeks to push the concept of water safety to gain awareness similar to that of "don't talk to strangers."

Client Profile – The Person

Michelle Zieg

What do WE know?	What do THEY want?
• Founder of <i>Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.</i> ○ Helped create Families United to Prevent Drowning ▪ (Blackstone, 2017) • Finds it daunting to ask for money ○ Donations suffer • Previously had a content calendar that has since been discarded	• Social media and website improvements needed • Would put money toward better branding/marketing if she had all the money in the world • Wants people to put water safety into broader perspective

Client Profile – The Brand

What do WE know?	What do THEY want?
• Gentle, family-oriented branding • Multiple nonprofit partners	• AWARENESS! ○ Awareness brings funding!

○ SafeKids ○ MUSC Injury Prevention ○ CPSC Pool Safety Campaign ○ Charleston County P&R ○ City of Charleston Rec ● Pediatrician on standby, as well as small team of volunteers ● Leverages endorsement from Michael Phelps Foundation	● More appealing and accessible presentation as a whole
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Competitors to *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.*

Classifying competitors can be tricky as organizations like Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. aren't fighting for profits, let alone competing at all. Non-profits, especially those of similar mission and nature, choose to cooperate and combine resources instead of competing. Although, there is still an unspoken competition for donor attention, partnerships, and reach within the community. However, one non-profit can do something better than another, regardless of the money behind it. In the end, non-profits fight for awareness, and awareness brings money.

This section will identify direct (very similar), indirect (slightly similar), and distant competitors to Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N using three criteria.

- **Services:** How similar are the services offered? What sets them apart?
- **Audience:** What demographics are being targeted?
- **Geography:** Is the non-profit located in the same area? What is their reach?

Such criteria will be used to compare Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. with the following three organizations.

- **Joshua Collingsworth Memorial Foundation**

- Partner to Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. with very similar origins. Joshua W. Collingsworth passed in a pool accident; parents started a foundation to educate wild safety. (The Joshua Collingsworth Memorial Foundation, 2020)(see reference 13)
- **Lowcountry Aquatic Project Swimming**
 - Partner to Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. “Provides water safety and swimming instruction to kindergarteners and first graders in Charleston County Title 1 schools.” (LAPS, 2019)
- **Charleston Waterkeeper**
 - “Charleston Waterkeeper is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization founded in 2009 to protect, defend, and restore the health and integrity of Charleston’s waterways for people and nature.” (Charleston Waterkeeper, 2022)

Competitor Type	Services	Audience	Geography
DIRECT Joshua Collingsworth Memorial Foundation	- Created the “Josh the Baby Otter” children’s book, used by Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. - Provides water safety education for children and parents	- Children - Parents	- Located in Nebraska - Global reach via “Josh the Baby Otter” children’s book
INDIRECT Lowcountry Aquatic Project Swimming	- Pool safety - Water education - Swim lessons and school partnerships	- Children - Parents	Charleston, South Carolina
DISTANT Charleston Waterkeeper	- Water quality testing - Habitat restoration - Mobile pump outs to drain sewage from water sources	- Children, adolescents - Parents	Charleston, South Carolina

The Nonprofit Industry

In 2022, *Mintel* (See reference 2), a market research firm, released their findings about the nonprofit market. While it is three years old, much of what was said and found can still be held true today. They found that since the COVID-19 pandemic caused economic turmoil, this led to a decrease in consumer confidence, and in the US, inflation reached a 40 year high. At the time, consumer confidence was at 59.9, and it can be reasonably assumed that it went down even more. They found that 47% of consumers were donating less due to the high inflation, making small donors even harder to come by. As an industry, this is leading to consumers' valuing connectivity to the company. In a study conducted by *Mintel*, 77% of respondents agreed that a lot of good causes get overlooked, and 69% said they can't afford to donate. In the same group, over half of respondents agreed they like to support causes with people like them. This shows how emotional and social identification are vital in motivating donors, especially during times of financial trouble. What has been suggested is that companies should try to offer something tangible. For example, nonprofits that give clear outcomes or physical rewards can boost their perceived value and donor trust. An interesting value found was that majority of American citizens agreed that nonprofits should be held to the same ethical standards as politicians, meaning companies should strive to make sure all personnel and the company carry out their duties as ethically as possible. This expectation shows the need for transparency in everyday operations and financial reporting, as donors might become skeptical of vague info. Working with for-profit companies has been used to help raise donations in the past. These partnerships normally help nonprofits reach new audiences, increase their reach, and lead to more donations. On the consumer end of the interactions, the report gives some good information. On the social media side, only about 13% of consumers share posts made by non-profits, demonstrating a lack

of engagement on the personal sharing side. This shows that while awareness might be high, active participation might not be at the same level, which is difficult for nonprofit marketers. On the consumer side of the industry, a study conducted found that the number 1 reason for individuals not supporting a nonprofit was a lack of funds at 62%, with not enough time to volunteer at number 2, with 21%. Men specifically are the harder gender to reach, with a quarter not donating because they don't know how funds are spent and 37% donating to a cause that impacts those close to them. But 50% of men are more likely to donate because of media and tend to give higher dollar amounts compared to women. This means that strategic storytelling and emotion-based campaigns could be important in getting more men to be consistent donors.

Loyalty plays a big part in donations, with around half of donors willing to donate again to the same company. While donating directly is seen as the most common option, other ways to donate can be easier for consumers. The second most donated way is through rounding up an order from a typical company. This is a quick and relatively low cost for the consumer to help make a difference, especially if they personally agree with the message. These methods lower the barrier to entry for donors and can help always keep revenue consistently high for nonprofits. Overall, the nonprofit industry is a unique industry that needs to be taken as its own area, not an offshoot of a typical industry. With rising costs and new technology, nonprofits need to learn how to adapt and grow.

SWOT Analysis

Strengths	Weaknesses
-It is for a good cause -Good connections with the community -Strong connections with large organizations and donors -Educational and relevant material -Presence at multiple conferences, both tabling and fundraising -Established Water Safety Day -Low operating costs	-Lack of staff -Small geographical operating area -Lack of brand awareness -Subpar website optimization -Little funds -No stable source of revenue -No prior nonprofit experience
Opportunities	Threats
-Connections with established donors -Unestablished areas nearby -New houses with pools -Child safety programs are becoming more common -Other nonprofits willing to work together -Local businesses who want to help	-Inflation and economic downturn -Other, more established nonprofits -Communication challenges (reaching out to new people) -Lack of support for the cause -Being suppressed by algorithms -Indifference to safety -Higher costs as expansion continues

Strengths

Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. is a company which has multiple strengths attached to them.

The most obvious one is that the cause is very sympathetic. Most adults with kids can sympathize with losing a child, making this cause one that they may not relate to but understand. This emotional connection can create a strong connection with donors through strong storytelling and engagement with the community. Along with that, they have very strong connections with their local community, even hosting **Water Safety Day**, which aims to make water safety important but also make it fun. It is here that they distribute their educational materials which aim to inform more people about the importance of water safety, which is created and shipped by

a third party. This event also creates opportunities for partnerships with local schools, swim centers, and first responders who can help spread awareness to a larger audience. Along with that event, Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. also attends other events, such as conferences, where other nonprofits can be reached, and more materials can be distributed. Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. also has connections and partnered with the Michael Phelps Foundation, which allows for a larger audience to be reached, along with more funding from wealthy individuals and companies. Finally, with it being a one-man show, there are relatively low operating costs, as there no overhead and no staffing costs, allowing most of the donations to go directly to increasing awareness.

Weaknesses

What they suffer from is an accumulation of issues stemming from one huge issue: a lack of staff. As of now, there is only one person working consecutively here, and that is the owner/CEO Michelle. This limited workforce limits the organization's outreach, its ability to maintain consistent communication, and grow in general. It is due to this issue that leads to poor website optimization. Looking at the website, there are significant issues with how it is set up. The site has a lack of structure with subcategories strewn across the screen. Improving the user-friendliness of the site could boost engagement and credibility. The text could be organized better, which leads to the site not being displayed on search results as high as some other companies. This plays a part in the issue of lack of brand awareness. The company has a lack of brand awareness outside of the main regional community and some niche communities, which is played in part with another weakness, the small operating area. While Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. has attended national events, they are only known in North Charlotte, South

Carolina. This limits how many people know about the company, and in hand, donations. Playing along with that, little funding impacts how the company impacts others. Less opportunities are available due to the high cost, and these opportunities could have more impact on the market. With this, a lack of stable revenue comes into play. While most nonprofits do rely on donations, the more established ones can estimate how much they can make each year and allocate those costs. In this scenario, donations seem to come and go, making it harder to save up to purchase new items and attend new events. Finally, since Michelle has no prior experience running a non-profit, it can lead to some challenges. Non-profits are much different than for-profits, and running one can be challenging, leading to complications.

Opportunities

While these are issues, there are some opportunities that, if acted on, can help the outcome of Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. With the established connections with other donors, this can be leveraged for a variety of outcomes, such as more funding and new companies to talk to. Another opportunity is the fact that with Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. operating in such a small area, there are other places nearby that may have limited exposure, which can yield new donors. In the United States as a whole, *IBIS World* (See reference 14) reported on the pool industry in 2025 about increasing revenues, either prices are going up or more pools are being made. With the second option, this means more families will have access to a pool, and since some of the families will have younger children, they will need a guide for water safety and may be willing to donate. Child safety programs have also been becoming more common, and parents are seeking out said programs, which will lead them to Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. for water safety. Along with the

Michael Phelps Foundation, other nonprofits will most likely want to partner up to help raise awareness. This can lead to more opportunities to reach new donors and increase water safety awareness. Local businesses may also want to partner up as it can increase goodwill for them and boost the local community.

Threats

As time goes on, more threats emerge that will impact Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.'s donations and ability to reach new donors. The biggest issue that all industries, not just the nonprofit sector, is economic downturn in the United States. According to the Bureau of Labor Statistics ^(See reference 12), currently, the unemployment rate is at 4.3%, inflation is at 3%, and costs continue to grow past the CPI of the prices of the same products years ago. This is leading to consumers saving money, making it harder for them to decide if they should donate or not. Along with that, the news company *Forbes* released an article in 2025 titled “*Roughly half of U.S. states are effectively in a recession and ‘hanging on by their fingertips,’ Moody’s chief economist says*” ^(See reference 12). In this article, Moody’s Analytics' Chief Economist described how parts of the US are in a recession, which backs up what the Bureau of Labor Statistics reported. Apart from that, established nonprofits in the same sector are also a threat. While they can sometimes help, they also demand attention from consumers, creating noise that makes reaching consumers harder. Along with that, communication troubles are an issue, as not only noise, but reaching out to new people, as emails can’t get taken from people that haven’t interacted with the company before. More unique communication methods may have to be leveraged to reach them. A lack of support may also threaten the company's reputation. While above it did say that the cause is something people will sympathize with, some people, possibly thus with no kids or who

know anyone who drowned, won't be able to fully understand the impact that Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. is trying to make. This will make it difficult to understand why they need to donate and thus impact funding. They may also be indifferent to safety, which will make the entire company's message obsolete. On the social media side, algorithms are everything and can determine who sees your posts. Unfortunately, if the content doesn't align, this can suppress the company, making it a challenge to reach people. Finally, as the company expands, the cost of running the business will increase, making donations a necessity to continue operating. Overall, Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. is in a strong position, and if its issues and opportunities are fixed and enacted, it will grow and prosper.

Primary Research

We conducted a single study during the campaign going over the effectiveness of the new website. While this will be gone more in depth during the relevant section, we will discuss some of the methods used. We gathered a group of participants and had them engage with the old website and the new mockup one using the iMotions eye tracking and facial recognition features at the University of Akron Suarez Labs. We then asked two questions, which one did you prefer, and why? See results in Campaign Recommendations: Complete Site Refresh.

Secondary Research

The drowning awareness nonprofit sector focuses on tackling a major global health issue. Drowning is currently the third leading cause of unintentional injury deaths worldwide, taking around 300,000 lives every year. More than 90% of these deaths occur in low and middle-income countries. This shows the urgent need for increased funding and education in areas where access to water safety resources is limited. Organizations in this sector work on a range of efforts, including public education campaigns, research, prevention programs, and policy advocacy. While challenges remain, there has been notable progress, which is proven by the fact that global drowning rates have dropped by about 38% since 2000.

Several key organizations are dedicated to the mission of preventing childhood drowning and promoting water safety awareness. Each plays an important role surrounding this critical issue. Swim Safe Forever focuses on preventing childhood drowning through education and scholarship opportunities. The organization emphasizes the importance of teaching children and families water safety skills, while also offering financial support to ensure that cost is never a

barrier to learning how to swim. Live Like Jake is another leading organization committed to bringing awareness to drowning prevention. Through outreach, education, and support for families affected by drowning incidents, Live Like Jake strives to increase public understanding of how quickly and quietly drowning can occur, promoting proactive safety measures around water. Levi's Legacy centers its efforts on community outreach by promoting the concept of a designated "Water Guardian." Their message encourages adults to always assign one responsible individual to actively supervise children anytime water is accessible, even when swimming is not planned, to prevent unnoticed accidents. The Colt Catalina Foundation aims to raise awareness for drowning prevention and child safety. The foundation uses education and events to engage communities and inspire greater attention to the everyday risks that lead to drowning incidents among children. Water Safe, Inc. Works to save young lives and reduce preventable injuries through comprehensive water and sun safety education. In addition to hosting an annual water safety event, the organization provides a swim lesson scholarship program that allows children to receive lessons at no cost to their families, ensuring access to lifesaving skills.

1. 44% of 2,000 internet users that are 18+ years old participate in swimming and other water sports/activities. "Multicultural consumers, including 78% of Asian and 76% of Hispanic individuals, show an interest in meeting new people through outdoor recreation, compared to 70% overall." (Source: See reference 1)
2. "Millennial men tend to place more emphasis on social issues, which may explain their stronger connection to philanthropic content from brands (31% vs 19% of Millennial women). Younger men are more likely to spend money on nonprofits, highlighting their desire to support meaningful causes. This focus on social impact likely drives their preference for brands that showcase responsibility and align with their values." (see reference 2)

3. “84% of Gen Zers report that they support nonprofit organizations, charities, or causes in some way.”
 - a. “Key giving channels for Gen Z’ers include opportunities that fit in the flow of their daily lives, such as donating at checkouts, at events, and via social media. 42% say they tend to engage spontaneously with causes and organizations. “
 - b. “Among employees of companies offering these programs, 89% and 92% of Gen Zers participate, respectively.” (see reference 3)
4. Over 90% of drowning deaths occur in low and middle-income countries, with children under the age of five being at the highest risk. (see reference 4 and 5)

Target Market & Market Segmentation

Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N. focuses on preventing childhood drownings by educating families and communities about water safety. Therefore, the primary target market centers on individuals most directly impacted by this mission, which are parents and caregivers of young children rather than solely those who donate financially.

Primary Target Market:

Parents and caregivers of children ages 0–8, particularly those living in Charleston County and surrounding coastal South Carolina communities. Children in this age range are at the highest risk of accidental drowning, making this audience the most emotionally receptive and motivated to act.

Typical Characteristics:

- Women ages 25–45
- Middle-income households
- Actively involved in children’s early learning and safety
- Seek trustworthy, practical safety guidance

Their motivation is rooted in **protection, prevention, and family well-being**, not just charitable giving.

Secondary Market (Influencer Groups):

These groups help expand water safety education and amplify reach:

- Schools and Preschools – trusted learning environments
- Daycare Centers and Camps – supervise children in active play settings
- Pediatricians and Clinics – parents trust medical recommendations
- Recreation Centers and Swim Schools – direct involvement with water activities

Engaging these groups through partnerships, presentations, or informational materials strengthens *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.*'s credibility and impact.

Customer Persona

Primary Persona: "The Safety-Focused Parent"

Name: Sarah Thompson

Age: 34

Location: Charleston, SC

Occupation: Elementary School Teacher

Family: Two children (ages 3 and 6)

Primary Summarization:

Sarah values education, community involvement, and her children's safety. She is emotionally moved by personal stories, especially those involving preventable tragedies. However, she often feels overwhelmed and needs clear, simple safety guidance. She is most effectively reached through school partnerships, community events, and relatable storytelling on social media.

Demographics:

Sarah represents *millennial mothers* who are highly active in their community and prioritize their children's safety and education. This aligns with Pew Research (2023), which found that parents aged 25–45 are among the most proactive in community safety and child welfare issues. See reference 11

Psychographics:

- Values education, family time, and community involvement.
- Emotionally moved by real stories of loss and prevention.
- Believes strongly in local action and wants to support causes that protect kids in her area.

Pain Points:

- Overwhelmed with responsibilities and lack of time to volunteer regularly.
- Unsure which nonprofits are trustworthy or where donations go.

Motivations:

- Wants peace of mind knowing her kids are safe around water.
- Responds strongly to *emotional storytelling* and *personal experiences*, such as Michelle Zieg's story (Blackstone, 2017).
- Prefers small, tangible ways to contribute (e.g., "round up for safety" donations, quick online gifts).

Engagement Behavior:

- Follows local causes on Facebook and Instagram.
- Shares water safety posts that feature children or community events.
- Attends local family events like "Water Safety Day" or community pool sessions.

Best Way to Reach Her:

- Social media storytelling with photos of families and kids.
- Partnerships with schools, preschools, and pediatricians.

Secondary Persona: "The Practical, Prevention-Minded Parent"

Name: James Rivera

Age: 42

Location: Mount Pleasant, SC

Occupation: Sales Representative

Family: One child (age 5)

Secondary Summarization:

James's values practicality, responsibility, and credible information. He is cautious about nonprofit transparency and prefers to see a measurable impact. He responds well to trusted endorsements, clear statistics, and short educational videos. He may not engage emotionally as quickly, but once convinced, he supports causes with meaningful, focused outcomes.

Demographics:

James represents *Gen X fathers* who value safety and practical action. According to Mintel (2022) and Giving USA (2024), men are less likely to donate than women unless they see clear transparency and impact — but they tend to donate *larger sums* when they do.

Psychographics:

- Analytical thinker who wants proof of impact.
- Engages with causes that directly affect his family or friends.
- Believes in teaching responsibility and safety to his child.

Pain Points:

- Doesn't always trust how nonprofits spend their funds.
- Doesn't have time to volunteer due to work and travel.

Motivations:

- Wants to protect his child and prevent tragedies.
- Prefers clear, measurable outcomes (e.g., “Your \$25 helped 10 kids attend a swim safety class”).
- Drawn to *celebrity endorsements* and partnerships, such as Michael Phelps' support.

Engagement Behavior:

- Donates online after seeing stories in the media or from trusted figures.
- Shares educational content occasionally but rarely engages without a strong emotional appeal.
- Responds to email newsletters or short impact videos.

Best Way to Reach Him:

- Clear, data-driven messaging (“Here’s what your donation accomplishes”).
- Partnerships with well-known organizations (SafeKids, MUSC, Michael Phelps Foundation)

SB7 Framework

1. Character:

- Target Segment: Parents and caregivers aged 25-45
- What do they want: To support a cause that makes an impact

2. Has a Problem:

- External Problem: Doesn't have time to volunteer or support.
- Internal Problem: A social responsibility to support a good cause.
- Philosophical Problem: Families deserve access to vital water safety knowledge and support.

3. Meets a Guide:

- Empathy: "Like you, we understand that life gets busy and there isn't always time to support the community. But even the smallest donation makes an impact on the lives of others."
- Competency and Authority: "We have partnered with organizations like Safe Kids and the National Drowning Prevention Alliance and attended numerous water safety conferences such as the National Water Safety Conference to provide valuable education and resources, supported by our own personal story."

4. Gives Them a Plan:

- Learn about our organization
- Spread the word to others and stay connected with *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.*

5. Call Customer to Action:

- Tell Families to enroll their child in swim lessons today
- Support our cause through donation
- Bring partners to *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* to help spread water safety

6. Help Them Avoid Failure:

- Without proper education, more children will remain at risk of drowning.
- A lack of training could result in tragedies
- Missing the chance to partner with *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* means missing out on supporting a lifesaving cause

7. End in Success:

- Success means more families are trained and educated.
- Stronger Community Awareness
- *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* creates a positive, de-stigmatized culture surrounding water safety.

Creative Message

Small Changes, Big Ripples

Our creative message “Small Changes, Big Ripples” is a representation of the idea that simple actions can lead to powerful outcomes. It shows that preventing tragedy normally begins with small steps like locking a pool gate or taking a swim class. Each action taken creates a ripple effect, which spreads awareness and safety through families and communities. Our message is also closely related to Brayden’s story, where small decisions have the ability to make an immense difference. It changes the mindset around water-related tragedy and shows that education and awareness can save many lives. This message can also apply to the client, Michelle. Small changes spearheaded by fresh resources will create big ripples among her donors, audience, and potential followers. The image of ripples in water shows that everyone has the power to make an impact, no matter how small their effort may seem. The message promotes the fact that no matter your situation or demographic, responsibility and mindfulness around water are highly important. It focuses on turning the fear of tragedy into hope and optimism. In other words, the biggest changes normally begin with simple choices.

Campaign Objectives

Communication Objectives

1. Reach six new communities

With this objective, we would be able to reach new people that would otherwise not be able to learn about the brand. As of now, *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* mainly operates in Summerville, SC, which limits the amount of people that could learn about the company. By expanding our local and social reach, we can reach new donors and improve awareness about drowning. When new people are interacted with, they will spread the brand and make more people aware of the brand.

2. Improve Search Engine Optimization

One of the most important ways to increase awareness is to improve a website's search engine optimization. In simple terms, Search Engine Optimization (SEO) is how a website ranks compared to others in geographic areas. Search engines like Google use crawlers to look at a website, see the information it offers, and will display the site based on keywords the searcher uses. There are many ways to improve SEO, but the best way is to improve a website's structure. If this is done correctly, hopefully, we can see an increase in website traffic from March 2026 to March 2027 at about 200 website visits a month.

3. Bring in newsletter subscribers

A great way to make people aware of anything is to send them an email. Through emails, you can inform people about events, donations, etc. Right now, there is an email list, but it is underutilized. If more people are encouraged to sign up, our following can increase. As of now,

there is no one signed up on the list, so we need to start from the ground up, which presents a challenge, but will make it easier to bring in new people.

4. Raise the number of followers and interactions across TikTok, Instagram, and Facebook

A big part of marketing is social media, as it is a relatively cheap and effective way to reach audiences. As of now, the three main platforms that the client uses are Facebook, Instagram, and TikTok, with the following counts as 1800, 229, and 92 respectively. It would be ideal to raise the follower count by 20% across all platforms by the end of March 2027. We recommend more of a focus with Instagram and TikTok.

Marketing Objectives

1. Increase the amount of donations from small donors

Small donors play an important role in a non-profit, as they not only provide funding, but also can be the recipients of the service the non-profit provides and can introduce new people to the message. As this campaign will mainly focus on smaller donors, we will want to focus on how much money we receive from them. From our information, *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* made around \$1750 from small donors in the 2024 fiscal year. Ideally, increasing donations to \$4000 will allow us to expand our operations and reach new communities.

2. Increase repeat donors

A crucial part of a non-profit is to have repeat donors. According to *Donors to Education Nonprofits* by Stelter, around 26% of donors do repeat donations (as of 2017). Loyalty plays a

crucial role in this, as the loyalty a customer has to the company dictates how much and how often they will repeat purchases. For *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.*, having repeat donors will guarantee a solid revenue stream allowing us to plan events that may require funds. We should aim to have around 20% repeat donors.

Tracking Metrics

Everything discussed so far needs to be tracked using specific metrics to gauge the level of success thus far. Below are the ways to track each objective:

Reaching six new communities

The easiest way to track this is just to make a list of the recommended areas to travel and interact with and cross out each place after they have been visited. It would also be beneficial to track each area's unique metrics; for example, see how many email list subscribers you received in the week following a high school visit from the district you visited. This will allow you to see how successful each area is and where to focus on the most going past this campaign

Improving Search Engine Optimization

The main metric that should be used to track SEO of the new website should be website visits. Squarespace allows you to do this, and you can easily see how it performs when it goes live. Ideally, getting around 100 unique visitors per month would be great, and *Squarespace* allows not only that to be tracked, but also geography, Google search keywords(what words lead people to your site), activity log(how people navigate the site), and the bounce rate(how many people leave the site after visiting just one page). Then you can easily adjust the website to accommodate any issues or if traffic is below the recommended amount.

Bring in email subscribers

If you use MailChimp as recommended, you can track multiple metrics, such as open rates, click-through rates (amount of people who clicked a link in the email), unsubscribe rates (how many people unsubscribed from that email), conversion rates (how many people did a specific desirable action), audience insights, and many more. These should be tracked every time you send out an email so you can tweak and improve each email going forward.

Raise follower/interaction count for TikTok, Instagram, and Facebook

TikTok, Instagram, and Facebook all make it relatively easy to track analytics with a user-friendly interface. For TikTok, it can track views, total view time, average time per view, engagement rate, and follower growth. Facebook tracks likes, page views, shares, post-performance, and engagement. Instagram tracks reach (how many people saw said post/reel), engagement follower growth, and post metrics. Ideally, checking in once to twice a month to see how each profile is performing would be good enough, and with paid advertisement, you can track how many people saw a post organically vs the paid method.

Increase the amount of donations from small donors

The current site for all donations for *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* is Zeffy, and can track source of visits, donor information, and unique visitors. While there are more analytics, these are the main ones to follow. We would classify a small donor as someone who donates less than \$100 per donation and less than \$300 per year. The best way to track how many new small donors contribute to the cause is just to see how many unique donors contribute over the course of the campaign. This should be monitored during the whole campaign, not just during specific timeframes like some of the other metrics.

Increase repeat donors

As stated above, repeat donors are crucial to ensuring a “constant” revenue stream for a non-profit. With the above metrics, use the individual donor metric and track how many times they donate per year. Two or more times would classify them as a repeat donor.

Campaign Recommendations

Physical Flyers

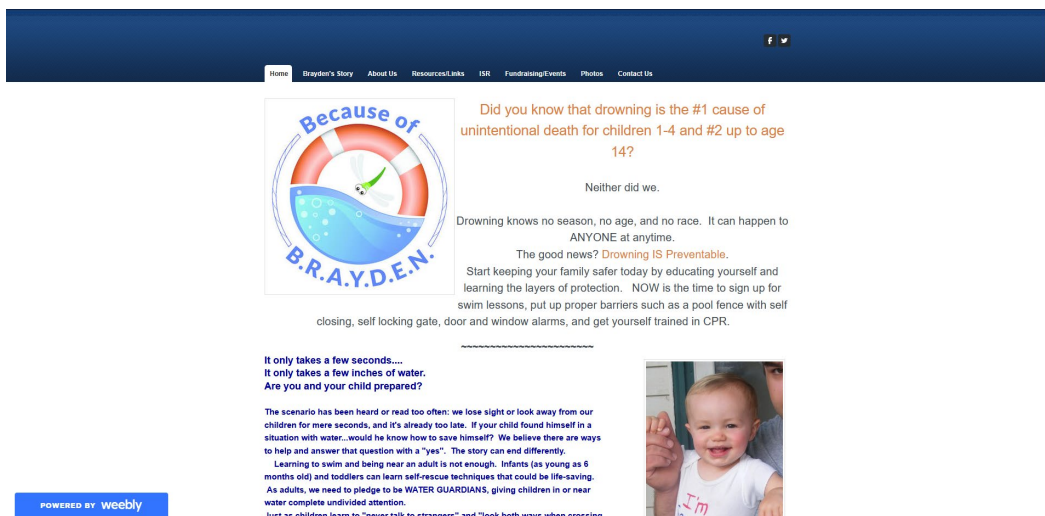
One deliverable that would help increase awareness about not only *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* but also water safety as a whole is laminated flyers going over how to be safe in water. During the presentation, a mock flyer will be presented and can be used immediately after buying licensing for the images. This flyer will go over the ins and outs of water safety, along with a QR code leading to the website and the logo at the bottom. These flyers can be posted at waterparks, public pools, recreation facilities, or anywhere with prior authorization. The call to action will drive people to the site to learn more and be inclined to donate to help the cause. New and current flyers can be distributed at future events to keep costs down.

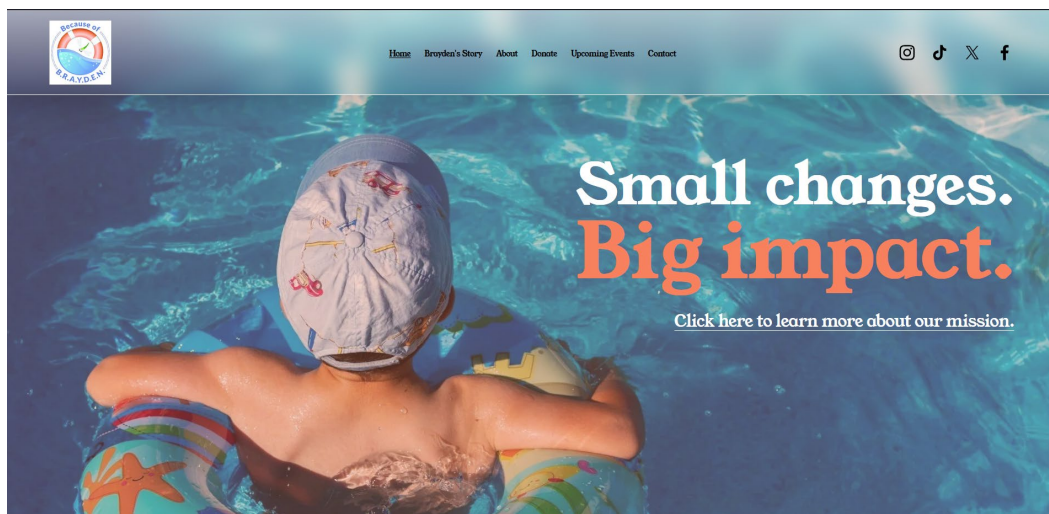
Complete Website Refresh

(trombone-hawk-pk8r.squarespace.com -- Password: becauseofbrayden)

As it stands, the current website has seemingly not been updated outside of event announcements. Weebly, the website host, has significantly fallen behind competitors such as Squarespace and Wix in terms of ease-of-use, customizability, and features. While Weebly is a free and decent platform, the client stands to benefit from a paid website that can manage certain aspects of a website, including SEO, without much interaction to save time. We wanted to create an affordable website that is ready to ship whenever desired while accommodating modern standards and preserving *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.*'s message. We also wanted to stay true to

the warm and parental attitude of the original site while making it a stronger platform for *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* activities, events, and social media. The host platform we decided to create this new website on is Squarespace-- but why? We chose this because Squarespace's website design is managed through blocks; section-by-section customization with plenty of depth and customizability if desired. Additionally, Squarespace offers free videos for one to hone their skills with web creation, hosting, and customization, making it easier to learn about a new system. To make the move to Squarespace easier, the client's current website domain can be transferred to the new site with no change in link appearance. The subscription we recommend purchasing is the "Basic" plan priced at \$16 dollars a month when purchased annually. With this plan, all the essential features are included, and two contributors can be added to make it easier for board members to add and edit website content. The following images compare the old and the proposed site.





After the presentation, the website is able to be transferred to the client. **The client will then need to provide a payment processor, an email list, and changes to the board section on the “About Us” page as needed.** High resolution pictures are needed on all pages, along with additional pictures of Brayden on the “Brayden’s Story” page. The client can also connect a Google Drive, Zapier, or MailChimp account to collect forms and email lists. For the site to be successful, it should have around 100 unique visitors a month, a bounce rate of 10%, monthly SEO updates to increase the likelihood of people finding the site through search queries.

Note: The About Us page is missing partners CEF Foundation, Jabari, and the Katelyn Foundation as these partners lead to dead links on the current website.

As mentioned earlier in the paper, we conducted a study with the eyetracking software and hardware from iMotions. The results are as follows: Overwhelmingly, people preferred the newer website, and when asked why, a common theme was that it looked a lot more modern and easier to use. This demonstrates that the new website has a higher potential to bring in and retain individuals than the old website.

Email refresh

The current email list, as far as we know, isn't utilized too much throughout the year. Emails are a useful way to communicate to many people all at once and inform them of events, issues, and anything else they should know. The best website to use would be *MailChimp*, as many companies use it and it's easy to use. The pricing is around \$13 a month and allows 500 contacts to be included, making it the best for an introductory start. Monthly recap emails should be sent out, going over any future events, past events, goals, and any other information. This should include a link to sign up for events, and also a button to donate and help the company. Past the monthly email recap, other emails can be sent out that would be smaller, such as informing about an event coming up or a large collaboration with another organization. This will help keep people engaged and follow how the company is performing. At least 10-20 people should be subscribing per month, with a click-through rate of around 80%, conversion rate of around 20% for donating, and unsubscribe rate of less than 10%.

See appendix images 9, 10, 11, 12

Canva Brand Kit & Content Calendar

Brand elements and colors are also available through the created Canva Brand Kit. Canva is a content creation platform designed for ease of use and comfort, utilizing templates and graphics to leverage user creativity. With the original content calendar falling by the wayside because of outside obligations, the new approach for Canva's Content Calendar is to automate posts and take advantage of specific dates and opportunities. This calendar can coordinate posts across platforms including Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, and LinkedIn while tracking

impressions, clicks, likes, and comments. The Brand Kit will allow the client to make branded posts that stay in line with the mission statement with elements that can be easily edited and uploaded quickly.

See images 1, 2, and 3

Social Media Reel Series

In the future, year-round posts should be done and also split into three main categories: Mission, Education, and Events. Mission posts are reels/images that are dedicated to defining the cause behind *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* These posts should be completed first before moving onto others. For example, tell Brayden’s story and pin it to the top of the account. This is the hook— WHY should someone care about a child drowning in a pool? Pull at the heartstrings of someone who might come across it on Instagram or any related platform. Education posts are dedicated to de-stigmatizing drowning-related incidents. Another example can be establishing credibility among viewers with graphics/charts that show how the viewer should take drowning seriously. It is important to understand that no one goes on social media for charts, so elaborate on different perspectives and open the comments up for discussion. Events' posts are pretty self-explanatory, where you can talk about upcoming and previous events. Before an event, announce the date, time, and location via a video post/reel and periodic “stories” the week leading up to the event. If the event has been done before, use previously acquired footage to create the content. After the event, post images and videos showing how participants had fun or educated themselves. These posts help to spread awareness of the mission and encourage people to follow. Followers will then be more likely to donate and support the mission. Ideally, we should be looking for a follower increase on Instagram to 1,000 overall followers, 3,000 on Facebook, and

200 on TikTok. Along with that, shoot for around 50-60 interactions per Facebook post, 20-30 for Instagram, and 5-10 for TikTok. See images 4, 5, and 6

Swim Meet Fundraiser: Laps for Brayden

Laps for Brayden is a community event where people would have the opportunity to compete, learn about water safety, and have a good time at the pool with their family and friends. People have the ability to join timed laps, relay races, and any other event that they please. Volunteers and lifeguards would most likely be provided to help run the events safely, time the races, and log the results of the event. Families and spectators are encouraged to watch, cheer, and take part in photo opportunities. Registration fees cover basic costs of the event, including pool rental and staffing. Donations are welcome throughout the day to support the cause. Attendees can contribute via donation tables, QR codes, or by purchasing event merchandise. Local businesses can sponsor races and donate supplies and/or refreshments. This support helps lower costs and increase involvement within the community. Educational materials would be included prior to and periodically during the meeting for kids and parents to inform them of how to be safe around water. The event schedule is structured to allow breaks between races and time for socializing. Lifeguards remain on duty for the entire day to make sure everyone is safe at all times. Volunteers assist with check-in, timing, and answering participant inquiries between events. Medals and ribbons would be awarded to participants as a fun memento as well as to encourage individuals to sign up. See image 7

We contacted a potential host to hold the Laps for Brayden event: the Summerville YMCA. When asked about their indoor pool, Tony Schupp, the Assistant Aquatics Director,

described the indoor facility as too small to hold larger events. However, the outdoor pool is frequently used to rent out birthday parties as well as special events on occasions, such as the Coast Guard using it for scuba training. Mr. Schupp made it clear that a fundraising event would be welcomed. When asked about pricing, Schupp said that it would depend on expected attendance and the length of the event. Based on our research, pool rentals for four hours range from \$200-\$400, so we allocated \$350 under Pool Rental fund for this purpose. While not reflected in the “Pie in the Sky Goals,” this fund can have another \$50 to \$100 allocated if needed while remaining under the “big” \$4,000 budget. Contact the Summerville YMCA contacts listed below for more information.

Summerville YMCA Contacts

Susan Nesselrode, Aquatics Director - susann@summervilleyymca.org

Tony Schupp, Assistant Aquatics Director - Tony.Schupp@summervilleyymca.org

Education Sessions

Another event addition is a 30-minute education session in-person or through an online workshop if necessary. They should be going over the basics of pool and water safety, followed by preventative drowning strategies. You should also provide a downloadable water safety checklist for participating in the in-person session or doing the online workshop, or, to save time and costs, provide previously created water watcher cards. These should be done in the same districts as the high school events listed above. We suggest visiting Berkley County, Dorchester County, Colleton County, Orangeburg County, Charleston County, and Beaufort County.

Budget

Most of the operation costs for this campaign will come from social media. The overall budget is in the table below:

Reason For Purchase	Price
Misc. Printing	\$68.50
Basic annual plan on Squarespace	\$192.00
Canva Pro (annual)	\$120.00
MailChimp (annual)	\$156.00
TikTok paid adverts	\$260.00
Instagram paid adverts	\$260.00
Facebook paid adverts	\$260.00
2x6 ft. Vinyl banner	\$31.00
100 medals	\$150.00
Hydration Stand	\$65.00
Pool Rental Fund	\$350.00
250 participation ribbons	\$87.45
TOTAL	\$2000.00

These costs were derived from the following:

- Miscellaneous printing: Estimate based on printing quantities of small flyers
- Squarespace: Basic Plan Annual subscription cost
- Canva Pro: Annual subscription cost
- MailChimp: Annual subscription cost
- TikTok, Instagram, and Facebook paid advertising: 1 dollar a day for 260 days, excluding December through mid-February
- 2x6 foot vinyl banner: Via GotPrint.com (see references for Laps for BRAYDEN)
- 100 medals: Based on AAA Awards (see references for Laps for BRAYDEN)
- Hydration Stand: Based on Walmart's pricing (see references for Laps for BRAYDEN)
- Pool rental: See Swim Meet Fundraiser: Laps for Brayden
- 250 participation ribbons: Based on AAA Awards (see references for Laps for BRAYDEN)

All of these costs are subject to change, but we believe, as far as we know, this is what it would cost to execute the marketing campaign as of now.

Timeline

In our following recommendation, we will describe an ideal schedule that organizes our previously mentioned deliverables within a calendar year. This section is meant to coincide with standard *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* operations.

March 2026

- Implement new website
 - With ownership transferred to you, you are now able to transfer the original website domain to the new website.
 - Sign up for the annual Basic plan, set up a payment processor, and upload high-resolution images to be used on the site. Upload the original mailing list.
 - Update the new website calendar with existing events.
- Purchase and use Canva Pro. Play with the new Brand Kit and edit elements as needed.
(NOTE: The annual Canva Pro plan must be purchased)
 - Make three social media posts per week. Get into the habit! This month's posts are meant to get you back on the "algorithm," and they don't need to be of high quality.
- Flyer Upkeep
 - Post *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* promotional flyers around the Summerville area
 - QR codes link to social media platforms
- Event Planning

- Begin reaching out to local middle and high schools regarding “Laps For Brayden” events mentioned in the appropriate section.
 - Contact middle/high schools through their contact forms listed on their websites.
 - Establish credibility with past education events and partners
 - Event to be hosted on November 14th
 - Ask if they have run similar events and if you can take part
 - If not, use the rules established in the “Swim Meet Fundraiser: Laps for Brayden” section
 - Contact potential sponsors/providers
 - Michael Phelps foundation
 - Local cafes, caterers, etc.
 - See if previous partners are willing to table or provide services/volunteers

SOCIAL MEDIA CONTENT	SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
• Stories • Text Posts • Videos • Infographics • Behind-the-Scenes • Education • Tips • Event Announcements	1 New website launched!	2	3	4	5	6	7
	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
LEGEND	15	16	17	18	19	20	21
● SOCIAL MEDIA POST ● EMAIL NEWSLETTER ● EVENT OUTREACH ● FLYER UPKEEP ● SOCIAL MEDIA STORY	22	23	24	25	26	27	28
	29	30	31				

April 2026

- Make three social media posts per week.
 - Follow the “Mission” and “Events” post structures as described in the "Social Media Reel Series" section.
 - Make a 10 second reel describing *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.*’s mission
 - Make two image posts about upcoming events
 - If no other events are coming up soon, make lighthearted content
 - Post **your** story. Tell the audience how much Brayden means to you and what that meaning can do for them.
- Visit one school district
 - Meet with elementary, middle, and high school
 - Discuss how to be safe this summer and the ABCD’s of water safety and other relevant material
 - Hand out the laminated flyer with the ABCD’s with the QR code to the website
 - Hand out some free merchandise
 - Discuss events that will happen soon and why they should come

May 2026

- Host your first Laps for Brayden event at a local Summerville pool
 - Take videos and pictures! These should later be posted on social media
- With a familiarity with Canva and the new website established, start to get comfortable posting three times a week. These posts do not need to be complex, and you are incentivized to use the Canva Brand Kit to come up with quick content.

- Light “Education” posts are great at getting people engaged
 - Remember, show MORE and tell less.
- School district visit

June 2026

- Begin planning for an Education Session on Teams
 - Hosting an online seminar is an easier way to gather attendance quickly
 - Plan to host the seminar in July

July 2026

- Host your first Education Session through Teams
 - Once completed, gauge feedback either through participant feedback or a post-session email
- Keep posting consistently!
 - Utilize your Canva Content Calendar to come up with fun posts while mixing in the educational, mission-based, and event-related posts.

August 2026

- Visit another district, around a week into the school year
 - All three again, and same stuff as before

- Complete a mid-year assessment
 - Use the metrics to track the following:
 - Unique donors
 - Repeat donors
 - New followers across the three socials
 - Interactions across the three socials
 - Donations received so far

September 2026

- Visit school district

October 2026

- Visit one last school district before the year ends and swimming stops for the most part
 - Same material as before
- Laps for Brayden Event
 - Event incoming! Finalize sponsors, volunteers, providers, and get an all-clear from the host.

November 2026

- Laps For Brayden Event – November 14th

- *See month of March for event planning up until this month*
 - Encourage participants, parents, volunteers to share photos and tag *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* accounts
- Once the event is over, share photos and videos throughout the week and the week after
 - These photos can then be used on the website or elsewhere

December 2026

- Start putting up physical flyers around aquatic facilities or other relevant locations surrounding Summerville.
 - Recreation centers, clinics, public pools, waterparks, etc.

January 2027

- Take the time to gather feedback from newsletter subscribers and social media followers
 - This can be done through encouraging followers/subscribers to reach out via the Contact Us form on the website, or commenting on a dedicated social media post
 - Ask questions like:
 - Are followers/subscribers satisfied with social media offerings?
 - Are they satisfied with the newsletter?
 - Does the website need any changes?

- Do followers/subscribers perceive *Because of B.R.A.Y.D.E.N.* as a credible nonprofit?

February 2027

- Continue gathering insights and feedback from subscribers and followers
 - Keep pushing the necessary posts that encourage feedback

March 2027

- Take note of all social media analytics and relevant measurements (See the Measurements section below)
 - Instagram, Facebook, and TikTok offer their own analytics that can be downloaded and exported into spreadsheets.
 - These can be referenced and interpreted by board members or marketing consultants
 - Squarespace tracks basic analytics, which is great to gauge
 - Keep up on SEO!
 - Go to the section in the account dashboard and let Squarespace AI update all SEO if desired
- Visit one last school district

"Pie-In-The-Sky" Goals

By exceeding the minimum budget of \$2,000, we can enhance the quality of Brayden's brand identity and improve event onboarding. These costs seemed just a bit too out of reach for the initial budget, so we decided to include them here. The budget sheet can be found in the Appendix under Image 8, with all additions underlined.

- Designer Revamp of Color Palette and Logo
 - We believe a designer's touch could truly enhance the branding of Because of Brayden by creating new assets for the brand. These assets improve brand outreach by making the brand seem more professional and support-oriented rather than purely educational. We set aside \$200 to be used for hiring a professional designer.
- Laps For Brayden Attendance Shirts
 - 100 custom shirts for the first 100 attendees of the Laps For Brayden event. These shirts are walking promotional pieces—although somewhat too expensive for the initial vision of the Laps for Brayden event. We're pitching \$753 to be set aside for these shirts via ooshirts.com, but we recommend seeking cheaper options if found.
 - While not listed in the budget, consider more expensive/limited prizes for events/raffles such as custom swim parkas, inflatable tubes, and swimsuits.
- Social Media Campaign Duration Extensions
 - Extend the promoted social media posts to be year-round rather than throughout ideal pool months. Increases overall awareness.

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Laps for Brayden resources:

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<https://www.aaaaward.com/product/pinked-stock-ribbons>

-T-shirts - <https://www.ooshirts.com/designapp/sharing/5296124676>

-Hydration stand - <https://www.walmart.com/ip/Primo-Water-Countertop-Dispenser-Top>

<https://www.walmart.com/ip/Lamosi-9-oz-Clear-Plastic-Cups-Disposable-Plastic-Drinking-Cups-PP-Food-Grade-Material-500-Count/>

GotPrint 2 x 6 Vinyl Banner -

https://www.gotprint.com/products/banners/order?size=216&orientation=1&paper=23&color=1&quantity=1&turnaround=1&proofType=31&fileDelivery=5&grommets=115&hemming=70&galleryImageOverride=initial-1&_gl=1*10ty3gp*_up*MQ..*_gs*MQ..&gclid=CjwKCAiAlfvIBhA6EiwAcErpyf6AGUXwOwFuffscI7I4QlyeY4-FScNsop72pZvk_CrUCAklKNRYFBoCUFkQAvD_BwE

Appendix

Image 1:

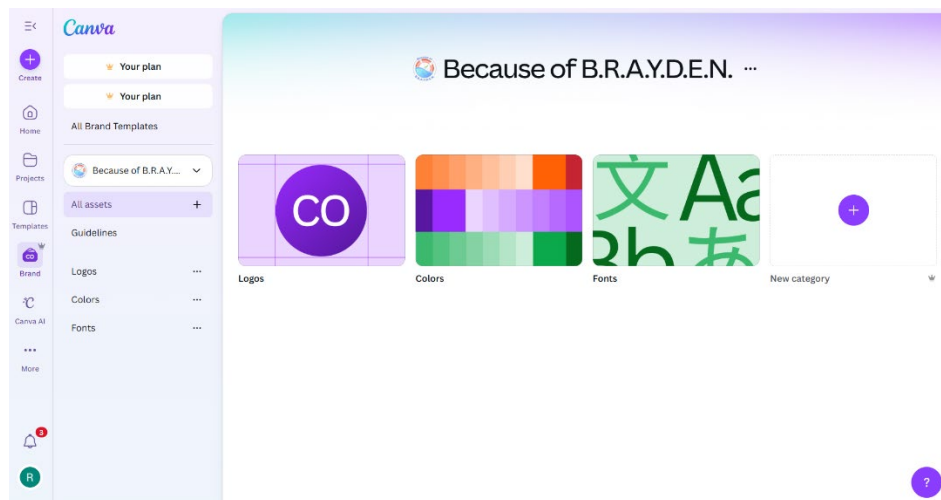


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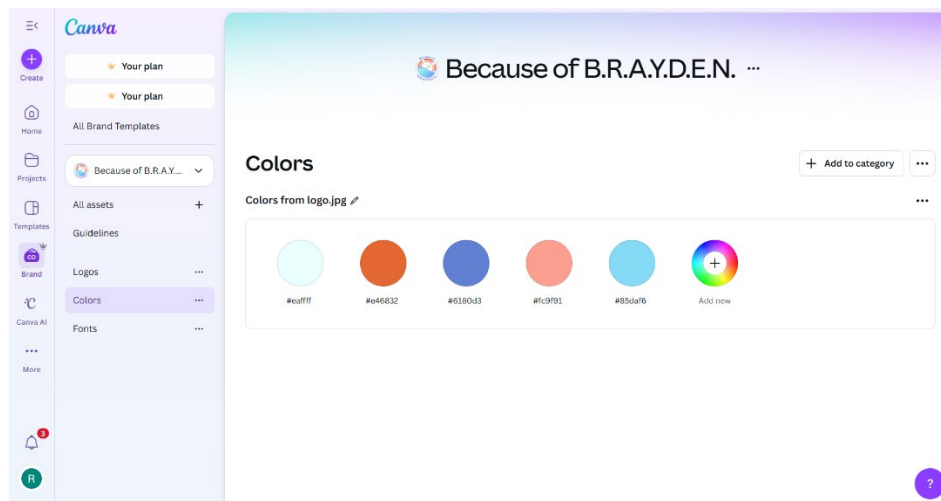


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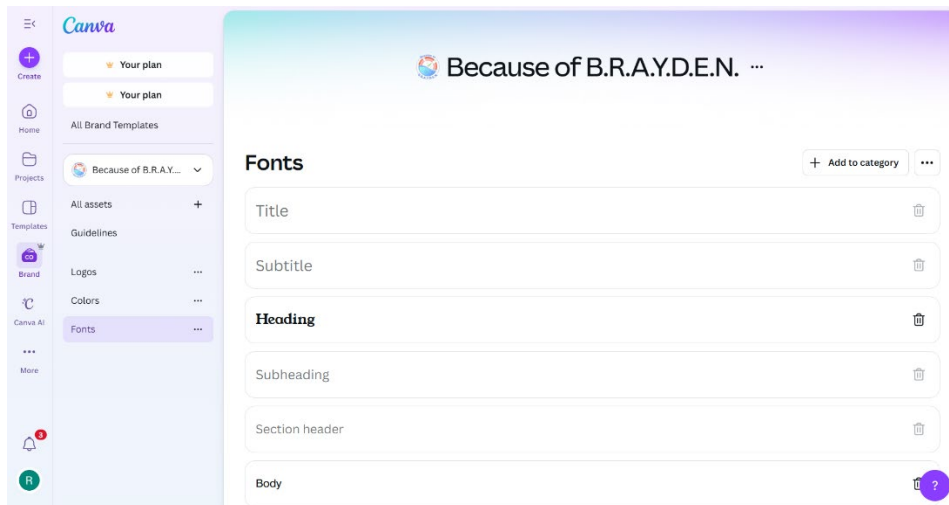


Image 4:



Image 5:



Image 6:

Because of Brayden
16th Annual Water Safety Day

We're hosting a hands-on event focused on preventing drownings and building safer habits — inspired by Brayden's story.
 Bring the family, learn something new, and help spread awareness.

JULY 15 23RD, 5-6PM

Join us for our 16th annual Water Safety Day!
 Charleston, South Carolina.

LEARN MORE ☎️ 123-456-7890 🌐 www.reallygreatsite.com

Image 7:



Image 8:

PIE IN THE SKY BUDGET		
Campaign Element	Purchase reason	Price
Flyers	Misc. Printing	\$ 25.00
Site Revamp	Basic Annual Plan on Squarespace	\$ 192.00
	Logo and Palette Designer Pay	\$ 200.00
Social Media	Canva Pro (Annual)	\$ 120.00
	MailChimp	\$ 156.00
	TikTok Campaign (Year-round)	\$ 365.00
	Instagram Campaign (Year-round)	\$ 365.00
	Facebook Campaign (Year-round)	\$ 365.00
Laps For Brayden	2 x 6ft Vinyl Banner	\$ 31.00
	100 Medals	\$ 150.00
	Hydration Stand	\$ 65.00
	Pool Rental Fund	\$ 300.00
	100 Participation Ribbons	\$ 84.00
	Custom shirts for first 100 attendees	\$ 753.00
Total		\$ 3,171.00

Image 9:

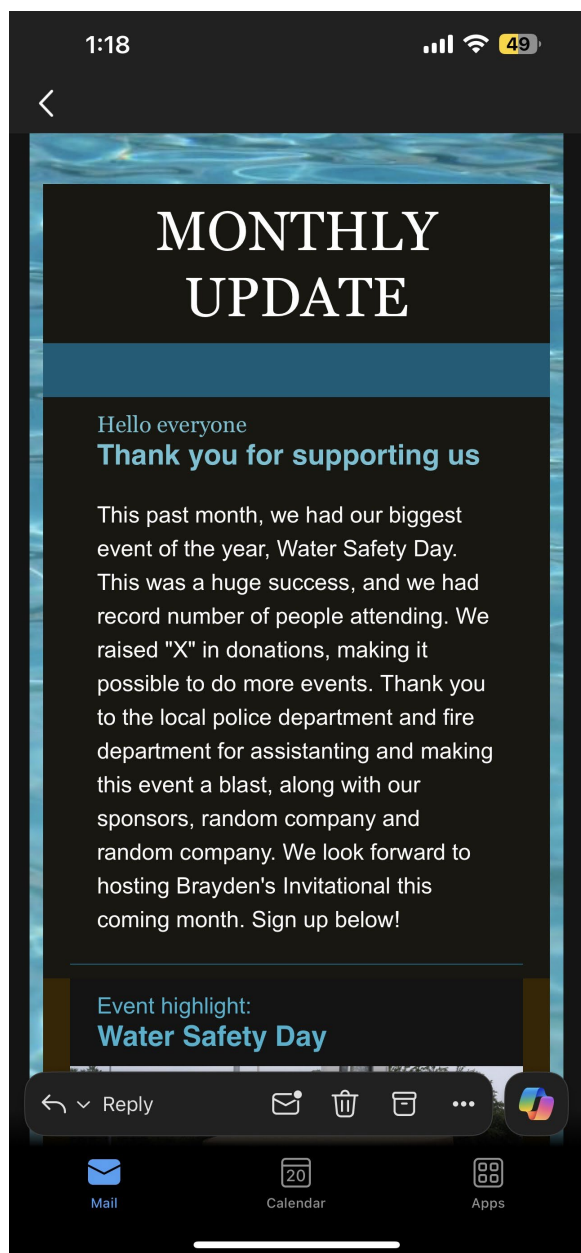


Image 10:

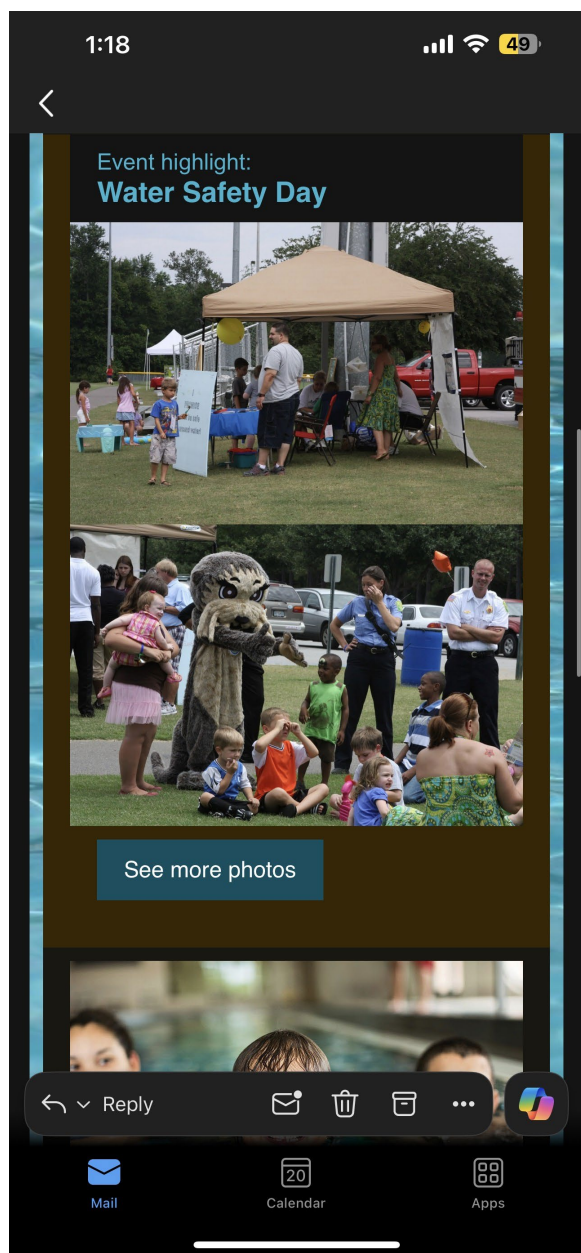


Image 11:

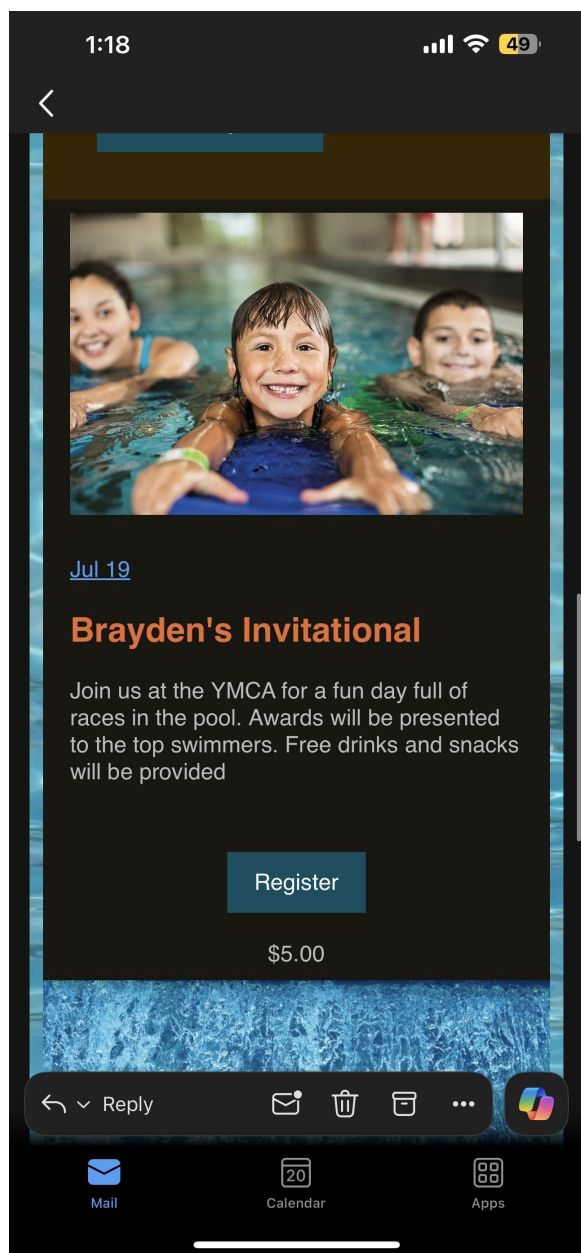


Image 12:

